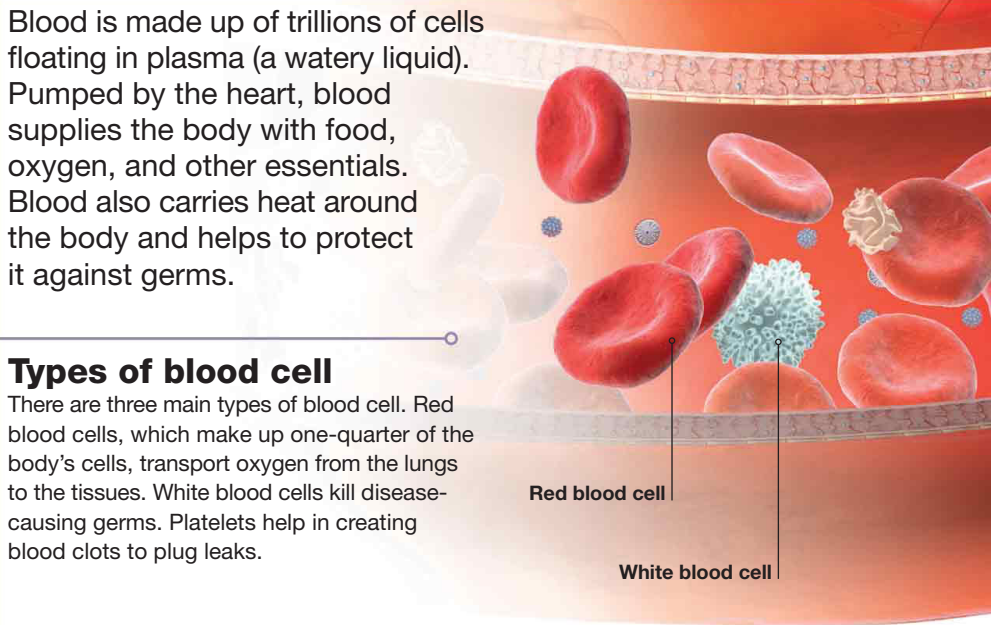


What's in blood?

Blood is made up of trillions of cells floating in plasma (a watery liquid). Pumped by the heart, blood supplies the body with food, oxygen, and other essentials. Blood also carries heat around the body and helps to protect it against germs.

Types of blood cell

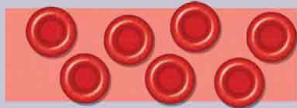
There are three main types of blood cell. Red blood cells, which make up one-quarter of the body's cells, transport oxygen from the lungs to the tissues. White blood cells kill disease-causing germs. Platelets help in creating blood clots to plug leaks.



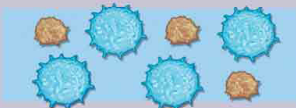
Red blood cell

White blood cell

BLOOD COMPONENTS



Red blood cells are filled with hemoglobin, a protein that is able to pick up and release oxygen. These cells also give blood its red color.



White blood cells and platelets aid the body's defenses. White blood cells detect and destroy invading germs, while platelets help to heal wounds.



Plasma is 90 percent water. The remaining 10 percent is made up of about 100 dissolved substances including nutrients, waste matter, and hormones.